

STATE OF NORTH CAROLINA

COUNTY OF VANCE

The Vance County Board of Commissioners met in special session on Monday, April 14, 2025 at 4:00 p.m. in the commissioners' conference room, Vance County Administration Building, 122 Young Street, Henderson, NC. Those commissioners present were as follows: Chair Carolyn Faines, Vice-Chair Yolanda J. Feimster, Commissioners R. Dan Brummitt, Charisse Fain, Thomas S. Hester, Jr., Leo Kelly, Jr., and Valencia L. Perry.

Absent: None.

Also present were County Manager C. Renee Perry, Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones, Finance Director Stephanie Williams, County Attorney Jonathan S. Care, and Clerk to the Board Kelly H. Grissom.

The purpose of the special meeting was to continue discussions on the detention center.

Delivery Method of Construction and Repairs. County Attorney Jonathan S. Care noted that during the board's April 7th regular meeting, he provided an outline of project delivery methods for new construction and repairs to the existing facility. Those included design/bid/build, CM at risk, and design/build. After further research on the matter, he recommends the design/build method for both new construction and repairs to the current facility. He provided six areas of criteria which justify the use of the design/build method.

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote unanimous, to use the design/build method for both new construction and repairs to the existing facility.

County Manager C. Renee Perry advised that the Request for Qualifications will go out this week.

Detention Center Deficiencies. Ms. Perry noted two Orders of Corrective Action letters received from the Department of Health and Human Services. The first letter dated April 1, 2025 prioritized action for the most immediate needs: depopulation, supervision rounds, contraband, staffing, and completing a comprehensive plan of correction. A second letter dated April 11, 2025 orders the appointment of an additional 20 deputies or law enforcement officers to work in secure areas of the detention center to supplement the existing detention officers.

Major William Mitchell appeared before the board and stated that 77 inmates have been relocated to other facilities and another 10 inmates are scheduled to be relocated this week. He is

currently in discussions with the district attorney's office and the superior court judge to hold an emergency session of court in order to further depopulate through adjudication. Commissioner Yolanda J. Feimster suggested that the cases of inmates charged with misdemeanors be expedited. Major Mitchell stated that he plans to submit to the state a list of deputies and law enforcement officers who can work in the detention center. He noted that this will not be an easy task because he is already short staffed. He can, however, use officers from other agencies if needed.

The board then discussed contraband being brought into the facility by employees and questioned why employees are not required to go through the body scanner. Sheriff Curtis Brame stated that the scanner is intrusive, and he will not subject his employees to this. Attorney Care stated that based on the current issues we are having, we may use the scanner for employees. The board suggested random searches by the scanner and/or K-9s.

Emergency Pay Policy. County Manager C. Renee Perry presented an emergency pay policy for detention services for a period of eight weeks. She explained that in response to urgent staffing needs, the policy is for current eligible staff members and approved personnel from partnering agencies. The budget impact is \$69,000 per month.

Following brief discussion, motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, vote unanimous, to approve the Emergency Pay Policy as presented.

Pay Grade Increase. Ms. Perry recommended that pay grades for the detention center be increased by one pay grade for the following positions: detention officer trainee, detention officer, detention center food services supervisor, detention liaison officer, detention shift supervisor, detention center supervisor (Lt.), and assistant detention center administrator (Captain). The detention center administrator pay grade will remain the same. The budget impact is \$2,500 per month.

Following brief discussion, motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote unanimous, to approve the pay grade increases as presented.

Jail Health Contract. Ms. Perry then asked for an update from the Sheriff's Office on the jail health contract with ACH. Major Mitchell stated that he feels ACH will not be terminating its contract now due to changes that have been made at the facility. Attorney Care requested Major Mitchell to request a letter from ACH stating that they are not terminating its contract.

Administrative Staff. Ms. Perry informed the board that unless otherwise directed by the board, county administrative staff must redirect their attention back to their own priorities such as budget, major projects, etc.

As there was no further business, at 5:05 p.m., motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote unanimous, that the meeting be adjourned.

Approved and signed May 5, 2025.

Carolyn Faines (signed)
Carolyn Faines, Chair